



Movies on iOS devices

Vudu has updated the iOS version of there app to download and view movie offline.
<http://dgit.in/14s439S>



Galaxy Tab with Atom

The Samsung Galaxy 10.1 Android tablet is expected to sport a dual-core 1.6GHz Intel Atom CloverTrail+ chip.

4. Costumes Tab

In this tab you can view and edit a sprite's costume. As mentioned earlier a sprite can have an unlimited number of costumes. You can add costumes to a sprite in four ways:

- **Paint** – You can paint a new costume for the sprite in the bundled paint editor. It is much like the Paint bundled in Windows without any added functionality.
- **Import** – You can directly import JPEGs, PNGs or GIFs as they are from your hard disk
- **Camera** – You can use your webcam to click photographs and use them as a costume.
- **Drag and Drop** – You can drag and drop an image from your desktop or a website.

You can export a selected costume as a new sprite by right-clicking on the desired costume in the costumes tab and selecting 'turn into a new sprite'.

5. Sounds Tab

You can record or import sound files in this tab which can be played along with your animation. Scratch recognizes MP3, WAV, AIF and AU files.

6. Stage

The stage is the place where all the action takes place. The sprites move and enact the actions specified in the scripts on the stage. The stage is 480 x 360 units in size. It's divided into a Cartesian grid with the center (0,0) in the middle of the stage. You can find your current position on the stage by checking the status tab at the lower-right corner of the Stage. You can switch sizes using the button on the top right corner. One thing to note, the stage itself is a sprite so double clicking on the stage or select the stage in the sprite list will open up it's script, background and sounds tab.

7. Sprite List

The sprite list contains the thumbnails of all the sprites inside a project. Double-clicking on a sprite opens it's script, costume and sound tab, the select sprite

is highlighted with a blue border. Scratch defaults to a cat's sprite when you open it, you can add new sprites by using the buttons on top of the sprite list. You can export sprites to a .sprite file which can then be used across various projects.

Programming

Scratch is billed as an environment/programming language which "makes it easy to create interactive stories, games, and animations". Albeit a toy language which is used for teaching, it contains nearly all constructs of a modern functional programming languages – variables, conditional statements, loops, operators and events.



Share away!

The blocks mentioned in the section above which are used to construct the scripts are divided into three sections.

Stack Blocks

These blocks have indentations on the edges which look like bumps and notches. Multiple such blocks can be snapped together to form a stack. Some blocks have input fields inside them which allow you to modify the menu either by typing it in or selecting one from a dropdown. Some stack blocks are C-shaped which allow you to place other stacks or blocks inside that block.

Hats

These blocks have a rounded top and must be placed on top of the stack for them to work. They listen for particular events and when the event is triggered they execute the block/stack attached below them.

Reporters

These blocks behave like variable and go into the input areas of some of the blocks of the other two types. Reporters with rounded borders will return string or numbers which can be used by other blocks, while the reporters with pointed ends return boolean values i.e. True or False. You'll usually find them being placed inside blocks with conditions. Click on any reporter to see it's current value. Some of the reporters will have a checkbox next to them, when you check such reporters a monitor appears on the on the stage which shows the current value of the reporter.

Scratch also allows you to create and manipulate lists. List is a type of variable and can be created from within the variable block palette. When you create a list, a monitor will appear on the stage. It will show all the items in a given list. You can enter items inside a list using a monitor. Scratch can also handle strings and user input. You can find the user input blocks in the Sensing block palette.

Sharing

Perhaps the most interesting aspect of Scratch is to share your code with the entire world, right from the interface itself. It's like Github but for mini games and stories. Everyone has the access to everyones code, you can download anyones project and start modifying the same is true vice-versa, such projects are called remixes. You're free to view and modify anyones image on the scratch website. This will help you learn interesting ways in which Scratch can be used to solve problems and a great way to learn new things about Scratch.

To start sharing your code you'll have to open an account on scratch.mit.edu. Once done with that you can put in the user-name and password in the share dialog in the interface, enter an appropriate project title and description and you're good to go. In case you're having problems uploading your project (the maximum project size supported is 10MB) you can try compressing the images and sound files from the edit menu in the application. 